transporting Chinese delegates to the conference experienced an explosion and crashed.) [68] Despite concerns among some participants that the Bandung conference was dominated by India and Nehru's star power, the conference itself resulted in a set of principles that condemned colonialism and established principles of peaceful coexistence. [69] As an American newspaper noted about Bandung, '[A]t last the destiny of Asia is being determined in Asia, and not Geneva, or Paris, or London, and Washington. Colonialism was out and hands off is the word. Asia is free. This is perhaps the historic event of our century.' [70] But given the prominence of Zhou Enlai's presence, the conference also helped facilitate the People's Republic of China's entry onto the international stage, to India's eventual detriment.

Bandung was a high-water mark for Non-Alignment, but the idea for a middle course between the two superpower-led blocs found resonance, including with Josip Broz Tito's Yugoslavia and Gamal Abdel Nasser's Egypt. Tito's visit to India in 1954 was a grand success, with Indians relieved to find a European leader whose views on global affairs mirrored their own. Meeting in July 1956 in the Brioni Islands in Yugoslavia, Nehru, Tito and Nasser had practical and ideological reasons to advance the notion of Non-Alignment and maintain some distance from Washington and Moscow. Nehru, however, expressed scepticism about a bloc or coalition, which was formalized with the inaugural Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) Summit in Belgrade in 1961. Unlike Bandung, the Belgrade Summit included participants not just from Asia and Africa, but also from Latin America and Europe. The political orientation of participating regimes was also more varied from conservative monarchies to avowed communist states like Cuba. Overall, the agenda deviated in several ways from Nehru's earlier preferences and risked becoming more rigid and less flexible. [71]

It is often overlooked today that India also helped facilitate Japan's re-entry into the international community after World War II. New Delhi refused to sign the San Francisco Peace Treaty of 1951 between Japan and the victorious allies of World War II. India deemed the agreement unfair and instead negotiated a separate agreement a year later, thus restoring ties with Tokyo. [72] Following visits by the Indian and Japanese prime ministers